

NIKOLAOS IOANNIS BOUNTOS



[GitHub](#)

[Google Scholar](#)

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Deep Learning, Computer Vision, Earth Observation

EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science Dec. 2025

Orion Lab, National Technical University of Athens & National Observatory of Athens

Degree awarded by Harokopio University of Athens

Thesis: *Multimodal Self-Supervised Learning for Earth Observation*

MSc in Data Engineering and Analytics Feb. 2020

Technical University of Munich

Thesis: *Subpixel Classification of Anthropogenic Features Using Deep Learning on Sentinel-2 Data*

BSc in Computer Science Sept. 2016

Aristotle University of Thessaloniki

Thesis: *Study of Causal Inference Algorithms*

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow May 2026 – Present

[Φ-Lab, European Space Agency](#)

Research on Earth Observation foundation models.

AI Researcher Jan 2021 – Dec 2025

[Orion Lab, National Technical University of Athens & National Observatory of Athens](#)

Supervisors: *Ioannis Papoutsis & Dimitrios Michail*

Led research on multimodal representation learning for Earth Observation, resulting in multiple publications in top ML conferences (ICCV, NeurIPS, AAAI) and Earth Observation journals (TGRS, ISPRS and others).

Contributed to EU projects including [DeepCube](#) and [ThinkingEarth](#).

Supervised master's and PhD students.

Research Intern Apr 2023 – Nov 2023

[Mila – Quebec AI Institute](#)

Supervisor: *David Rolnick*

Investigated methods for the creation and evaluation of sensor-agnostic, flexible foundation models for Earth Observation.

Visiting Researcher & Beyond Fellow Sept 2022 – Dec 2022

[AI4EO Future Lab, Technical University of Munich](#)

Supervisor: *Xiaoxiang Zhu*

Studied modality domination in multimodal representation learning in Earth Observation.

Artificial Intelligence Engineer Dec 2019 – Apr 2020

[Motius](#)

Developed deep learning methods for turbine fault detection using 3D point cloud data.

Master's Thesis on Computer Vision for Earth Observation

Apr 2019 – Sept 2019

[Esri Deutschland](#)

Supervisor: *Thomas Huckle*

Explored deep learning methods for subpixel land cover classification using UAV and Sentinel-2 data.

Working Student, Data Analytics

July 2018 – Feb 2019

[KPIT](#)

Performed log analysis and extracted actionable user behavior insights.

Working Student, Data Scientist

Oct 2017 – Jan 2018

[Trillr.com](#)

Designed and maintained a structured database for product and user traffic data.

Analyzed user behavior to generate actionable business insights communicated to stakeholders.

Automated business insights generation for improved decision making.

Web Developer

Dec 2016 – Apr 2017

[Newte](#)

Designed and developed custom websites tailored to client requirements.

Enhanced and extended features of existing websites.

AWARDS/SCHOLARSHIPS

- **Best Paper Finalist** at the **ICCV 2025** with our paper: **Towards a unified copernicus foundation model for earth vision.**
- **International Research Center on Artificial Intelligence under the auspices of UNESCO Global Top 100 list 2025** for the project: **Triton: Global Flood Monitoring system**, rated as **Excellent**.
- **Best Paper Award** at the **ICCV 2023 AI + HADR** workshop for our paper **TeleViT: Teleconnection-driven Transformers Improve Subseasonal to Seasonal Wildfire Forecasting.**
- **International Research Center on Artificial Intelligence under the auspices of UNESCO Global Top 100 list 2022-23** for the project: **Pluto - A global volcanic unrest early warning system**, rated as **Excellent**.
- **Beyond Fellow Scholarship** of the AI4EO Future Lab of the Technical University of Munich
- **European Union Agency for the Space Program - Cassini Challenge:** winner of the idea track

SELECTED TALKS

- [From coordinates to context: multimodal Location Encoders for food security.](#) UN World Food Programme (WFP) workshop, 2026, Rome.
- [Foundation Models for Earth Observation](#), Living Planet 2025, Vienna, Austria
- [A Practical Session on Deep Learning Advances for Monitoring and forecasting Natural Hazards](#), IGARSS 2024, Athens, Greece
- [Deep Learning for monitoring and forecasting natural hazards with earth observation data](#), IGARSS 2023, Pasadena, California

OTHER ACTIVITIES

- Co-organizer of the 2nd Workshop on Advances in Representation Learning for Earth Observation at NeurIPS 2026, Paris.
- Reviewer for NeurIPS 2025, 2026, CVPR 2026, AAAI 2026, IEEE Transaction on Geoscience and Remote Sensing, ICANN-23, Terrabytes II
- Scientific Committee for the ESA-NASA International Workshop on AI Foundation Model for EO.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Camps-Valls, Gustau, et al. "Bridging the weather and climate divide with artificial intelligence." *Nature Communications* 17.1 (2026): 8578.
- [Kondylatos Spyros*](#), [Nikolaos Ioannis Bountos*](#), Michail Dimitrios, Zhu Xiao Xiang, Camps-Valls Gustau, Papoutsis Ioannis. "On the Generalization of Representation Uncertainty in Earth Observation." *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, 2025.
- [Nikolaos Ioannis Bountos*](#), [Maria Sdraka*](#), Angelos Zavras, Ilektra Karasante, Andreas Karavias, Themistocles Herekakis, Angeliki Thanasou, Dimitrios Michail, Ioannis Papoutsis. "Kuro Siwo: 33 billion m^2 under the water. A global multi-temporal satellite dataset for rapid flood mapping." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* 37 (2025): 38105-38121.
- [Nikolaos Ioannis Bountos](#), Arthur Ouaknine, Ioannis Papoutsis, and David Rolnick. "Fomo: Multi-modal, multi-scale and multi-task remote sensing foundation models for forest monitoring." *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*. Vol. 39. No. 27. 2025.
- Wang, Yi, Zhitong Xiong, Chenying Liu, Adam J. Stewart, Thomas Dujardin, [Nikolaos Ioannis Bountos](#), Angelos Zavras, Franziska Gerken, Ioannis Papoutsis, Laura Leal-Taix'e and Xiao Xiang Zhu. "Towards a Unified Copernicus Foundation Model for Earth Vision." *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, 2025

*First two authors contributed equally.